

THREAT DOSSIER

Linux Shell-Script Dropper // "k.php"

SHA - 256

02aac4d201886e01abd2e3d42a20edcb4e6c2381549de19df0b9166607cd3f51

Assessment: HIGH RISK • Linux • Dropper • Persistence • Credential Access • Defense Evasion

ANALYST NOTE The sample is best described as a malicious Linux shell-script dropper with Trojan-like behavior. An exact malware family is not consistently established across the public sources: MalwareBazaar lists the threat as unknown, Hatching Triage reports no family, while ReversingLabs labels it Linux.Trojan.Egairtigado.

Prepared from MalwareBazaar intelligence, linked sandbox results, the supplied VirusTotal behavior reference, and provided screenshots.

What is this malware?

A concise technical interpretation of the selected sample and why it matters.

The selected file, **k.php**, is not actually a PHP web file based on its detected content. MalwareBazaar identifies it as a **Linux/UNIX shell script** (MIME type `text/x-shellscript`). This mismatch is consistent with masquerading: the filename looks like one type of file while the content behaves as another.

The sample functions as a **dropper** — a small first-stage program whose job is to fetch or place additional malicious content on a system. MalwareBazaar reports that it uses standard command-line download utilities such as `wget`, `ftpget`, `curl`, and associates it with the remote URL `http://160.119.69.4/x`.

BOTTOM LINE This is not merely a suspicious script. Multiple independent engines classify it as malicious, and sandbox behavior shows capabilities tied to persistence, system discovery, credential access, privilege escalation, defense evasion, and modification of security-relevant Linux files.

Sample attribute	Observed value
Filename	k.php
Actual file type	Linux/UNIX shell script (.sh)
Size	50,071 bytes
First seen	2026-08-27 10:04:48 UTC
SHA-256	02aac4d201886e01abd2e3d42a20edcb4e6c2381549de19df0b9166607cd3f51
Delivery	Web download
Role	Shell-script dropper / Trojan-like activity
Exact family	Unconfirmed / inconsistent across vendors

How strongly is it detected?

Cross-vendor results show a strong malicious consensus, although one engine scored the file as legitimate.

Source / engine	Result	Score / confidence	Interpretation
MalwareBazaar	Vendor detections: 6	Threat listed as unknown	Repository has multiple detections but does not assign one definitive family.
FileScan.IO	Malicious	10/10; 100% confidence	Very strong malicious verdict; tags include base64, bash, evasive, LOLBin, masquerade, obfuscated.
Kaspersky OpenTIP	Malicious	~10 hits	Confirms malicious Unix shell sample.
Nucleon Malprob	Malware	92%	High probabilistic confidence that the script is malware.
ReversingLabs	Malicious	13/24 AV; threat 5/5	Labels sample Linux.Trojan.Egairtigado.
Hatching Triage	Malicious	8/10	Behavioral sandbox flags persistence, credential access, evasion, discovery, execution and privilege escalation.
ClamAV / SecuritInfo	Detected	BackDoor signature	Signature-based detection consistent with backdoor-like functionality.
YOROI YOMI	Legit	0.19	Outlier result; demonstrates why one engine alone should not determine final verdict.

DETECTION ASSESSMENT The evidence supports a HIGH-confidence malicious classification. The strongest basis is not one vendor name; it is the convergence of static signatures, high-confidence vendor verdicts, and observed sandbox behaviors.

VirusTotal note: The supplied VirusTotal Behavior URL is included as a reference source. In this report, behavior details are attributed to the publicly retrievable sandbox intelligence surfaced through MalwareBazaar/Hatching Triage rather than inventing VirusTotal-specific observations that were not exposed by the public web page.

What does it do after execution?

Observed actions grouped into an attack story instead of a raw list.

1. Reconnaissance / Discovery

Enumerates kernel and hardware configuration, reads runtime system information, checks CPU configuration, discovers network configuration, and enumerates running processes. This helps the malware understand the host and may also support anti-analysis decisions.

2. Payload Staging / Execution

Writes files into temporary directories and can deobfuscate or decode information. The YARA match specifically flags suspicious Base64-encoded shell command execution, suggesting that commands or payloads may be hidden from casual inspection.

3. Persistence

Creates or modifies cron jobs, Bash startup files, desktop-entry files, environment variables, and rc scripts. These locations can cause malicious commands to run again at login, startup, or on a schedule.

4. Credential & Account Access

Sandbox reporting includes OS credential dumping, modification of password files, and creation of a system user. These actions can help an attacker obtain credentials or maintain an alternate login path.

5. Privilege / Permission Changes

The sample modifies file and directory permissions. Combined with user/password-file changes, this can weaken host controls or enable continued access.

6. Defense Evasion / Evidence Removal

Deletes audit logs and system logs and exhibits obfuscated / evasive characteristics. This can reduce forensic visibility and make incident reconstruction more difficult.

7. Secondary Payload Retrieval

MalwareBazaar identifies the script as a dropper and associates it with a web-download URL. This means the first-stage script may be only the beginning of the compromise; subsequent payloads can expand the attack.

Why these behaviors matter

Likely consequences if the script executes successfully on a Linux endpoint or server.

Risk area	Potential consequence
Credential compromise	Credential dumping and password-file modification could expose or alter local account credentials.
Persistent unauthorized access	Cron, startup-script, rc-script, desktop-entry and account changes can allow the attacker to survive reboot or user logon.
System integrity loss	Permission changes and user/account modifications can undermine normal security boundaries.
Reduced forensic visibility	Deletion of audit and system logs can hide attacker activity and delay incident response.
Additional malware infection	As a dropper, the sample can retrieve another payload, meaning the eventual impact may exceed what is visible in the first-stage script.
Operational disruption	Changes to system configuration, startup behavior, accounts and permissions can destabilize services or force system rebuild/recovery.

Important limitation: The public evidence reviewed does not prove that this sample performed ransomware encryption or confirmed outbound data exfiltration. Those impacts should not be claimed without additional packet captures, decoded payload analysis, or sandbox evidence.

Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

IOC type	Value
SHA-256	02aac4d201886e01abd2e3d42a20edcb4e6c2381549de19df0b9166607cd3f51
SHA-1	ae23265a6c8bc1553a15bb396bba134cd71408a8
MD5	1c5901d763f5f0c1c3066a488b5f1aa7
Filename	k.php
Observed download URL	http://160.119.69.4/x
Dropped SHA-256	349c388f5bbdec382ea492b442f5f595792c55a6b0270b77e8aa77934e841f03
Dropped MD5	17a28d4f0fe20d786693a9d0c5aaccaa
YARA rule	SUSP_LNX_Base64_Exec_Apr24

Final assessment

A submission-ready interpretation tied directly to the assignment criteria.

Classification: Malicious Linux shell-script dropper / Trojan-like script — HIGH RISK.

The sample demonstrates a layered attack pattern. It first uses a lightweight shell script and common Linux utilities to stage or retrieve payloads. It then performs host discovery, alters persistence mechanisms, modifies users and password-related files, changes permissions, and removes logs. These behaviors would give an attacker multiple ways to maintain access while reducing visibility into the compromise.

The most important analytical point is that the filename alone is misleading: although the file is named k.php, automated file identification detects a shell script. That mismatch, plus Base64/obfuscation indicators and the use of ordinary system utilities, supports a defense-evasion / masquerading interpretation.

ASSIGNMENT CRITERIA CHECK Detection results documented ✓ | Behavioral indicators documented ✓ | Potential impact explained ✓ | Malware sample identified by hash ✓ | VirusTotal behavior reference included ✓

Suggested defensive response

- Isolate any host where the sample hash or associated dropped-file hashes are found.
- Block or investigate the observed download infrastructure and review proxy/DNS logs for related access.
- Review cron jobs, Bash startup files, rc scripts, desktop entries, environment variables, users, groups and password files for unauthorized changes.
- Preserve remaining logs and collect volatile evidence quickly because the malware is reported to delete audit/system logs.
- Hunt enterprise-wide using the SHA-256/MD5 indicators and the YARA rule, then examine any secondary payloads separately.

Screenshots supplied for the analysis

Visual evidence from the assignment criteria and MalwareBazaar sample intelligence.

Criteria

Identify and Analyze Cyber Threats

Demonstrate understanding of cyber threats through practical analysis. The project must include analysis of a malware sample using VirusTotal or Any.Run/Hybrid Analysis platform, documenting detection results, behavioral indicators, and potential impact. creation of 1 phishing template using Social Engineering Toolkit (SET) in Parrot OS/Kali Linux, and mapping of 1 real APT campaign to MITRE ATT&CK framework.

Figure 1. Assignment criteria: malware analysis must document detection results, behavioral indicators and potential impact.

MALWARE bazaar

from ABUSE¹⁰ | SHAMHAUS

Q Browse

Upload

Hunting Alerts

Access Data

Resources

Login

2026-08-27 10:32	09a2f164491a14034b50...	sh				d351d3r
2026-08-27 10:15	87785592937bbf8a8dfb...	exe	WannaCry	dionaea exe WannaCry		pawscobbler
2026-08-27 10:08	9b718c57f7aaeb2565a7...	sh				BlinkzSec
2026-08-27 10:08	ca755c4bbc937486b2d...	zip	Mirai	mirai		BlinkzSec
2026-08-27 10:08	bd18229fffc839a2b3676...	elf	Mirai	elf mirai		abuse_ch
2026-08-27 10:06	e6d627f52195c471cc35...	exe	Vidar	exe vidar		Anonymous
2026-08-27 10:04	02aac4d201886e01abd...	sh		sh		abuse_ch

Figure 2. MalwareBazaar browse view showing the selected shell-script sample among recent submissions.

File name:	k.php
Download:	download sample
File size:	50'071 bytes
First seen:	2026-08-27 10:04:48 UTC
Last seen:	Never
File type:	sh
MIME type:	text/x-shellscript
ssdeep	768:y+Y9GKYpr9GKYpr82fkR4nnA9GKYpr9GKYpr82fkR4nnS:y+Fcr
TLSH	T13A235C6516857C24AE98C4361C7E2F0CB9AD43E6324452EE7FCF3CF68C4A6AD910971D

Figure 3. Sample identity: filename k.php, 50,071 bytes, shell-script MIME/type metadata.

Intelligence

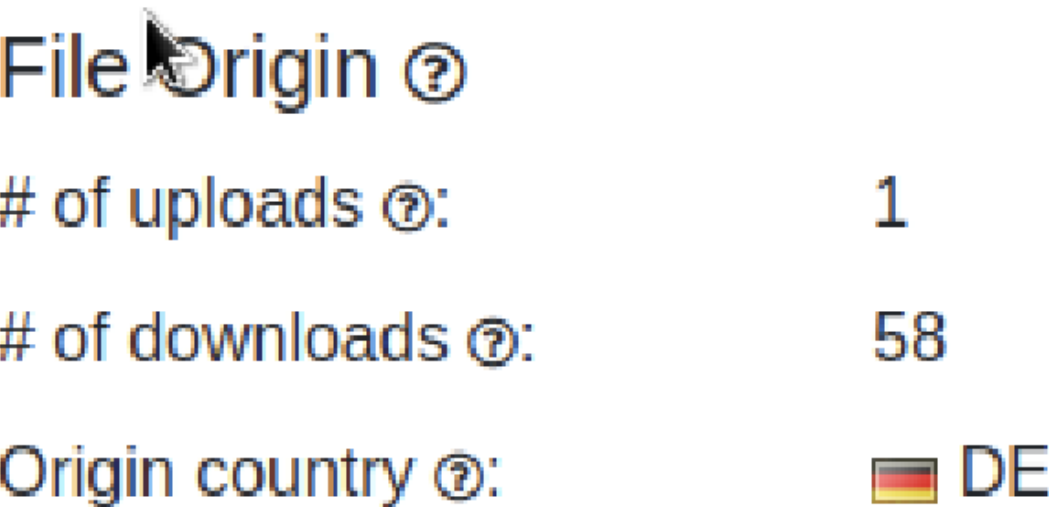


Figure 4. Intelligence panel: one upload, multiple downloads, origin country shown as Germany (DE).

YARA Signatures

MalwareBazaar uses YARA rules from several public and non-public repositories, such as [YARAhub](#) and [Malpedia](#). Those are being matched against malware samples uploaded to MalwareBazaar as well as against any suspicious process dumps they may create. Please note that only results from **TLP: CLEAR** rules are being displayed.

Rule name:	SUSP_LNX_Base64_Exec_Apr24  Alert
Author:	Christian Burkard
Description:	Detects suspicious base64 encoded shell commands (as seen in Palo Alto CVE-2024-3400 exploitation)
Reference:	Internal Research

Figure 5. YARA signature: *SUSP_LNX_Base64_Exec_Apr24*, identifying suspicious Base64-encoded shell commands.

References used

Public intelligence was correlated; no malware sample was executed or downloaded for this report.

MalwareBazaar sample record

<https://bazaar.abuse.ch/sample/02aac4d201886e01abd2e3d42a20edcb4e6c2381549de19df0b9166607cd3f51/>

VirusTotal behavior reference supplied with assignment

<https://www.virustotal.com/gui/file/02aac4d201886e01abd2e3d42a20edcb4e6c2381549de19df0b9166607cd3f51/behavior>

Hatching Triage report (linked from MalwareBazaar intelligence)

<https://tria.ge/reports/260827-l4nwbafq6w/>

METHODOLOGY This report uses open-source threat intelligence and screenshots only. The sample itself was not downloaded, opened, decoded, or executed. Conclusions distinguish directly observed public findings from analyst interpretation and avoid claiming an exact family where sources disagree.